

snowflake-id

A high-performance, zero-dependency 64-bit distributed unique ID generator for Node.js, inspired by Twitter’s Snowflake algorithm.

Bit Layout

Timestamp (41 bits) milliseconds since custom epoch	Datacenter ID (5 bit)	Worker ID (5 bit)	Sequence (12 bits)
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Property	Value
Max throughput	4,096 IDs/ms per worker
Unique workers	1,024 (32 datacenters × 32 workers)
Generator lifespan	~69 years from epoch
ID size	64-bit integer (returned as BigInt)

Quick Start

```
const { createGenerator } = require('./index');

const gen = createGenerator({ workerId: 1, datacenterId: 0 });

gen.nextId();           // → 929310234123423744n   (BigInt)
gen.nextIdString();     // → '929310234123423744'   (safe for JSON/DBs)
gen.nextIdHex();        // → '0ce9f4ab3d800001'     (hex, 16 chars)
gen.nextIds(5);         // → [BigInt, BigInt, ...]  (bulk)
```

API

`createGenerator(options?)`

Creates a single `SnowflakeGenerator`.

Option	Type	Default	Description
<code>workerId</code>	<code>number</code>	0	Worker node ID (0–31)
<code>datacenterId</code>	<code>number</code>	0	Datacenter ID (0–31)
<code>epoch</code>	<code>bigint number</code>	1577836800000	Custom epoch (ms, Unix)

```
const gen = createGenerator({ workerId: 3, datacenterId: 1 });
```

`gen.nextId()` → `BigInt`

Generate one ID. **Always use `BigInt`** — Snowflake IDs exceed `Number.MAX_SAFE_INTEGER`.

`gen.nextIdString()` → `string`

Generate one ID as a decimal string. Safe for JSON serialization and databases.

`gen.nextIdHex()` → `string`

Generate one ID as a zero-padded 16-character hex string.

`gen.nextIds(count)` → `BigInt[]`

Generate `count` IDs in bulk.

`gen.parse(id)` → `object`

Decode a Snowflake ID back into its components.

```
gen.parse(929310234123423744n);
// → {
//   id:          '929310234123423744',
//   timestamp:    1704067200123,
//   date:         Date { 2024-01-01T00:00:00.123Z },
//   datacenterId: 0,
//   workerId:     1,
//   sequence:     0
// }
```

`createPool(options?)`

Creates a `SnowflakePool` that round-robins across multiple workers. Use this when you need throughput beyond 4,096 IDs/ms.

```
const { createPool } = require('./index');

const pool = createPool({ datacenterId: 0, workerIds: [0, 1, 2, 3] });
pool.nextId();           // → BigInt (round-robins across workers 0-3)
pool.nextIds(1000);      // → BigInt[]
```

`parse(id, epoch?)` **(static)**

Parse a Snowflake ID without creating a generator instance.

```
const { parse } = require('./index');
parse('929310234123423744');
```

`SnowflakeGenerator.limits`

```
SnowflakeGenerator.limits;
// → {
//   maxDatacenterId: 31,
//   maxWorkerId:     31,
//   maxSequence:     4095,
//   maxIdsPerMs:     4096,
//   lifespanYears:   69
// }
```

Notes on BigInt

JavaScript's `number` type loses precision above $2^{53} - 1$ (~9 quadrillion). Snowflake IDs are 64-bit integers and will exceed this. **Always store and transmit IDs as strings.**

```
// ✗ Dangerous — precision loss
JSON.stringify({ id: Number(gen.nextId()) });
```

```
// ✓ Safe
JSON.stringify({ id: gen.nextIdString() });
```

Running Tests & Benchmarks

```
node test/run.js
```

File Structure

```
snowflake-id/
├── index.js           # Public API (factory functions + re-exports)
├── src/
│   ├── SnowflakeGenerator.js # Core ID generation logic
│   └── SnowflakePool.js      # Multi-worker pool
└── test/
    └── run.js               # Functional tests + performance benchmark
```